The Gem-Shaped Pad

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 17

A glittering gem-shaped decoration and a soft gel pad had similar outlines. Nib chose the glittering one for the reading rest. It looked magnificent and rocked beneath the short foot. Lark brought the supplies note closer before anyone placed a book on top.

“A gem of a solution,” Nib exclaimed proudly. “A gel solution,” Lark corrected with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cent**

“G can say /j/ in gem and gel,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare the hard g in get, which keeps its own sound. Read gem and gel through their different last letters. The soft sound is prepared in these examples; we won't change every g we meet.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try gem, gel, age. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read gel on the supply note,” Lark invited gently. “Which material can settle beneath the short foot?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **The gel is by the gem. I can get the gel.**

“Which thing can the speaker get?” Lark asked gently. “Read its last sound carefully.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the gem to the decoration tray. The gel pad compressed beneath the rest's short foot, and the broad top stayed level. Lark tested it with a light touch before putting anything valuable there. Phone remained in the boat while the borrower's message tube was checked.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write gel beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the useful pad beside the steady foot. Sparkle had not been the feature the rest needed. At the speaking tube, two wheels opened two different fittings, and the next note identified the right one.